

The following is a faithful transcription of typed notes by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

TO KNOW IS TO APPRECIATE;--is TO LOVE when the known is good,-
--is TO ADORE when divine.

What a consolation! What an outlook this ought to afford us! What an outstanding horizon for poor sinners--if "hope is the very soul of happiness here" and if the revealed purpose of our creation, "TO KNOW GOD" is kept in mind, --what a horizon for sinners if we but stop and remember that to KNOW GOD covers everything. Hence the lines:

God made me to know Him. O what a bless'd aim!
To love Him and serve Him sure rests in the same.
Its "Heaven Begun", for the grateful on earth'
To treasure aright? ! Highest Heaven its worth.

But how can I know what the senses fail to perceive? How know the incomprehensible God, whose attributes--wisdom and power and goodness and mercy--are infinite? A simple objection may demand in the first place simple answer, and besides there is a trite proverb: "A fool can ask questions that will puzzle a philosopher to answer." A nave can ask such questions. But after all every nave is a fool too. However, a simple answer to the above objection might be to ask another very simple question: "Do the senses perceive the electricity--"the juice"--in a live wire? Or again: Do men look at the sun itself to consider it benefits? Objections here are vain. No excuses.

If the primary purpose of my creation is to know my Creator so that I may love Him and serve Him and be happy with Him; and if no one but a fool can say in his heart, "There is no God", then the necessary conclusion would seem to be that God's existence must be manifest, one way or other, to everyone who is not a fool; consequently, that every normal person able to think can and ought to recognize his Creator--can and must worship God; and this under pain of losing everything good in the final, and of damning his own soul--cast out "into exterior darkness where there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth."